

Master List of Organizational and Leadership Artifacts

Methodology for Categorization and Ordering

This document organizes a comprehensive set of organizational, leadership, strategic, operational, and governance artifacts used across public administration, nonprofit leadership, business administration, and management consulting. The artifacts are categorized based on their primary purpose and domain of use.

Conceptual Hierarchy and Relationships

Foundational artifacts exist in a logical hierarchy that effective leaders must understand:

The Strategic Foundation (Identity Layer):

- **Purpose** (most stable) → **Vision** (aspirational) → **Mission** (operational) → **Values** (behavioral)
- Purpose answers "Why do we exist?" and remains highly stable over time
- Vision answers "Where are we going?" and provides the aspirational future state
- Mission answers "What do we do and for whom?" and describes current operations
- Values answer "How do we behave?" and guide daily decision-making

Key Distinction: Guiding Principles vs. Core Values

- **Core Values** are fundamental beliefs that define organizational culture (rarely change)
- **Guiding Principles** are strategic decision-making frameworks (adaptive to changing conditions)
- Example: "Honesty" is a value; "Prioritize customer satisfaction in every decision" is a principle

The Strategy-to-Performance Gap: Organizations typically achieve only 70% of their strategy's potential due to poor execution. Effective artifacts bridge this gap by providing clarity, ensuring alignment, and enabling accountability.

Critical Success Factors:

- **Avoid the Complexity Trap:** Strategic plans fail when they become "outsized and complicated," developed through committees that dilute clarity. Effective documents must be streamlined and prioritized.
- **Link to Performance Mechanisms:** Accountability requires that strategic artifacts are directly linked to performance reviews, compensation, or feedback mechanisms. If not, employees will prioritize tasks tied to their normal evaluations.
- **Active Governance Required:** Documents must be actively governed, not merely created. The stable foundation (Purpose/Values) must dictate the adaptive structure (Operating Model/Theory of Change), which must dictate measurement (KPIs/Evaluation).

The Universal Artifact Stack

Despite different terminology across sectors, nearly all organizations rely on the same core "stack" of foundational artifacts that flow from identity through accountability:

The Five-Layer Framework (Recommended):

Identity → Direction → Priorities → Action → Accountability

Translated into Specific Artifacts:

Vision & Mission → Guiding Principles/Values → Strategic Goals → Initiatives/Plans → Performance Metrics

This framework is typically implemented through **six foundational documents**:

1. **Vision Statement** - Aspirational future state (Identity)
2. **Mission Statement** - Current purpose and operations (Identity)
3. **Core Values** - Behavioral expectations and culture (Direction)
4. **Guiding Principles** - Decision-making frameworks (Direction)

5. **Strategic Goals** - Major 3-5 year objectives (Priorities)

6. **Strategic Priorities** - Current focus areas for resource allocation (Priorities)

Key Insight: The distinction between **Values** (cultural beliefs) and **Guiding Principles** (decision-making frameworks), as well as between **Strategic Goals** (long-term objectives) and **Priorities** (current focus), provides critical clarity for both strategy formulation and day-to-day operations. This 5-layer framework with 6 foundational documents makes implicit decisions explicit.

Functional Domains

Artifacts are grouped according to the functional purpose they serve. These domains include:

- Strategic Direction & Organizational Identity
- Governance, Oversight & Accountability
- Operational Management & Service Delivery
- Human Resources, Workforce & Leadership Development
- Finance, Budgeting & Resource Management
- Technology, Data & Digital Operations
- Risk, Continuity & Resilience
- Communications, Engagement & External Relations
- Evaluation, Learning & Improvement
- Specialized & Sector-Specific Frameworks

3. Ordering Within Categories

Within each category, artifacts are ordered from the most foundational and broadly used to the more specialized or advanced tools. For example:

- Mission → Vision → Values → Strategic Plan (foundational)

- Operating Model → Service Blueprints → Business Capability Maps (advanced operational)

4. Standard Format

Each artifact is presented with:

- **Name**
 - **Purpose** (what it is for)
 - **Example** (well-known or generic)
 - **Sectors** (Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting)
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A. Strategic Direction & Organizational Identity

1. Mission Statement

Purpose: Defines the organization's fundamental reason for existing and what it does for whom.

Example: "To organize the world's information and make it universally accessible and useful" (Google)
or "Partnering to deliver secure, reliable technology solutions" (public agency)

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

2. Vision Statement

Purpose: Describes the aspirational future state the organization seeks to achieve.

Example: "A computer on every desk and in every home" (Microsoft, 1980s) or "An equitable, sustainable future where all residents thrive"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

3. Core Values / Guiding Principles

Purpose: Articulates behavioral principles and cultural norms that guide daily decisions and actions.

Example: "Integrity, Collaboration, Accountability, Respect, Excellence" or Amazon's Leadership Principles

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

4. Purpose Statement

Purpose: Sits between mission and values; defines "why we exist" in a single sentence.

Example: "We serve Minnesotans by enabling secure digital government"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

5. Strategic Goals

Purpose: Major objectives aligned with the organization's vision, typically 3-7 long-term goals spanning 3-5 years.

Example: "Achieve carbon neutrality by 2030" or "Expand into 5 new markets"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

6. Strategic Priorities

Purpose: Current focus areas that organize work and resource allocation, often annual or biennial.

Example: "Digital transformation, Customer experience, Operational efficiency"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

7. Guiding Principles / Decision-Making Principles

Purpose: Frameworks that help choose between competing options.

Example: "Customer-first in all decisions" or "Prefer build over buy when core competency"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

8. Strategic Plan

Purpose: Comprehensive document integrating mission, vision, goals, strategies, and resource allocation over 3-5 years.

Example: Federal agency 4-year strategic plan, corporate strategic plan

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

9. Annual Operating Plan (AOP)

Purpose: One-year plan operationalizing strategic priorities into budgets and deliverables.

Example: Corporate AOP, nonprofit annual work plan, agency plan-of-work

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

10. North Star Metric

Purpose: Single, high-level measure that reflects the organization's ultimate value.

Example: "Time to delivery for public services" or "Households lifted out of homelessness"

Sectors: Business, Nonprofit, Public

11. Organizational Theory of Value / Value Proposition Framework

Purpose: Defines exactly what value the organization creates and for whom.

Example: Nonprofit value proposition canvas or "Faster. Cheaper. Better." (business)

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

12. Organizational Charter / Articles of Incorporation

Purpose: Legal document establishing the organization's existence, purpose, authority, and boundaries.

Example: Corporate charter (business), articles of incorporation (nonprofit), enabling legislation (public agency)

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

13. Organizational Minutes

Purpose: Official record of board decisions, votes, and actions taken; required for legal compliance.

Example: Nonprofit board meeting minutes documenting vote to approve annual budget

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

14. Organizational Narrative / "Story of Us"

Purpose: Shared narrative describing the organization's origin, purpose, core identity, and story of impact.

Example: "Founding Story + Turning Point + North Star" format used in nonprofits

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public, Business

15. Code of Ethics / Code of Conduct

Purpose: Defines ethical standards and expected behaviors, including compliance requirements.

Example: NASPAA Public Service Values, corporate Code of Conduct (Johnson & Johnson "Credo")

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

B. Governance, Oversight & Accountability

16. Governance Framework

Purpose: Defines decision-making authority, committee structures, meeting cadences, and escalation paths.

Example: Board → Executive Committee → Management Team; decision rights matrix

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

17. Delegation of Authority (DOA) Matrix

Purpose: Formal rules for who is authorized to approve what (purchases, decisions, contracts).

Example: Procurement authority matrix by dollar threshold

Sectors: Public, Business

18. Accountability Framework

Purpose: Clarifies responsibility, oversight, escalation paths, and enforcement mechanisms.

Example: Canadian government's Management Accountability Framework (MAF)

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

19. Board Governance Handbook / Matrix

Purpose: Defines roles and responsibilities of a governing board.

Example: Nonprofit board governance matrix showing board vs. management responsibilities

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public, Consulting

20. Internal Controls Framework

Purpose: Defines financial, operational, and compliance controls to ensure accuracy and reliability.

Example: COSO Internal Controls Framework

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

21. Oversight Framework

Purpose: Describes internal and external watchdog functions and oversight bodies.

Example: Inspector General oversight model

Sectors: Public

22. Performance Accountability Agreement

Purpose: Formal agreement between leaders and their governing body defining performance expectations.

Example: Commissioner performance compacts, Results-Based Accountability agreements

Sectors: Public

23. Board Minutes & Governance Records

Purpose: Formal documentation of decisions for legal compliance and institutional memory.

Example: Nonprofit board archives, executive steering committee minutes

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

24. Mandate Letter / Charge Letter

Purpose: Directive from an executive identifying priorities and expectations for a leader.

Example: Prime Ministerial minister mandate letters (Westminster governments)

Sectors: Public

25. Community Advisory Board Charter

Purpose: Defines community engagement governance structure.

Example: Health or human services community advisory board charter

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

26. Ethics Review Process Documentation

Purpose: Governs conflicts of interest, recusals, transparency, and disclosures.

Example: State ethics board review procedures

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

27. Whistleblower Policy

Purpose: Protects employees who report misconduct; required by Sarbanes-Oxley Act for public companies.

Example: Anonymous reporting hotline procedures and retaliation protections

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

28. Document Retention and Destruction Policy

Purpose: Defines how long records must be kept and procedures for destruction; prevents illegal document destruction.

Example: "Financial records retained for 7 years; email retention policy"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

29. Shareholder Agreements

Purpose: Defines rights, responsibilities, and relationships among company shareholders.

Example: Buy-sell agreement, voting rights structure

Sectors: Business

30. Board Committee Charters

Purpose: Defines structure, responsibilities, and operating rules for specific board committees.

Example: Audit Committee Charter, Compensation Committee Charter

Sectors: Business, Nonprofit

C. Operational Management & Service Delivery

31. Operating Model / Target Operating Model (TOM)

Purpose: Architectural blueprint showing how the organization executes its strategy through structure, processes, technology, governance, and people. Distinct from Business Model (which describes commercial activities/go-to-market); the Operating Model is the organizational "nervous system" or "engine" that executes the business model. Critical for closing the strategy-to-performance gap.

Example: Centralized vs. decentralized model, shared services design, McKinsey's "Organize to Value" framework

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Business Capability Map / Capability Framework

Purpose: Visual map of organizational capabilities needed to deliver on strategy (what the organization must be able to do).

Example: Strategic capabilities (planning, innovation), Core capabilities (service delivery), Enabling capabilities (HR, finance, IT)

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Enterprise Architecture Framework

Purpose: Aligns business strategy, processes, information, and technology systems.

Example: TOGAF enterprise architecture, FEAF (Federal Enterprise Architecture Framework)

Sectors: Public, Business

Organizational Structure

Purpose: Formal structure showing reporting relationships, roles, responsibilities, and hierarchies.

Example: Traditional hierarchy, matrix structure, flat organization

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

Service Catalog

Purpose: Defines all services offered, including SLAs, owners, and request pathways.

Example: IT service catalog listing all technology services

Sectors: Public, Business

Service Blueprint

Purpose: Maps front-stage (customer-facing) and back-stage (internal) service processes.

Example: Public library service blueprint

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Customer Journey Map / User Journey Map

Purpose: Visualizes citizen or customer experience through touchpoints and pain points.

Example: DMV customer journey, SNAP benefits application process

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

Service Level Agreements (SLAs)

Purpose: Documented expectations for service performance and response times.

Example: "IT help desk tickets resolved within 24 hours"

Sectors: Public, Business

Customer Charter / Service Standards

Purpose: Explicit, measurable commitments to customers about service quality.

Example: "We will respond to inquiries within 24 hours" or "99.9% system uptime guarantee"

Sectors: Public, Business

Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

Purpose: Detailed instructions for executing routine processes consistently.

Example: Employee onboarding SOP

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Operating Principles / "Rules of the Road"

Purpose: Short, tactical principles governing how teams work day-to-day.

Example: "Default to open," "Users before shareholders," "Document everything"

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Playbooks (Operations, Crisis, Communications)

Purpose: Action-oriented manuals for consistent execution of common tasks.

Example: Cyber incident response playbook, crisis communications playbook, volunteer management playbook

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

RACI Matrix (Responsibility Assignment Matrix)

Purpose: Clarifies who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed for major tasks.

Example: Project RACI showing R, A, C, I for each stakeholder role

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Purpose: Lean diagrams showing workflow, value creation, and waste.

Example: Employee onboarding process map

Sectors: Business, Public, Consulting

Knowledge Base / Process Library

Purpose: Central repository of SOPs, instructions, templates, and decision guides.

Example: SharePoint library for service delivery processes

Sectors: Public, Business

Operating Rhythm / Meeting Cadence Calendar

Purpose: Defines key annual/quarterly/monthly/weekly meetings, reviews, and reporting cycles.

Example: "Quarterly results review → Monthly cabinet meeting → Weekly standups"

Sectors: Business, Public

4. Human Resources, Workforce & Leadership Development

Leadership Competency Model

Purpose: Defines what "good leadership" looks like in the organization.

Example: Zenger/Folkman competency model, federal Executive Core Qualifications (ECQs)

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Leadership Philosophy Statement

Purpose: Defines a leader's personal theory of leadership and core beliefs.

Example: "I believe leadership is about servant leadership and empowering others"

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Competency Dictionary / Competency Model

Purpose: Defines expected competencies (knowledge, skills, abilities) for roles or leadership tiers.

Example: SHRM competency dictionary

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Role Architecture / Job Family Framework

Purpose: Classifies jobs into families, levels, and progression pathways.

Example: HR job family tree with career progression

Sectors: Public, Business

Workforce Development Framework

Purpose: Defines training, leadership development, and career pathways structure.

Example: Leadership development pathways, DOD Civilian Leader Development Framework

Sectors: Public, Business

Workforce Planning Strategy / Workforce Plan

Purpose: Future staffing needs, skills gaps, retirement risk, and recruitment priorities.

Example: State HR five-year workforce plan

Sectors: Public, Business

Succession Planning / Succession Management Plan

Purpose: Identifies critical positions and develops future leaders to ensure continuity.

Example: State agency succession plan, talent pipeline development

Sectors: Public, Business

Succession Pipeline / Talent Pipeline Map

Purpose: Identifies readiness of internal candidates for future roles.

Example: 9-box talent grid showing high performers

Sectors: Business, Public

Skills Inventory / Skills Taxonomy

Purpose: Catalog of organizational skills used in workforce planning.

Example: Technical and soft skills inventory

Sectors: Business, Public

Team Charter / Staff Charter

Purpose: Defines team agreements, norms, roles, and communication expectations.

Example: Agile team charter

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Onboarding Framework / Onboarding Journey Map

Purpose: High-level structure for new employee experience.

Example: 90-day onboarding journey with milestones

Sectors: Public, Business

Performance Review Framework

Purpose: Outlines how performance evaluations are structured and conducted.

Example: State competency model, 9-box talent grid

Sectors: Public, Business

Performance Calibration Framework

Purpose: Ensures rating consistency across supervisors.

Example: Calibration committees, forced distribution

Sectors: Business

Employee Value Proposition (EVP)

Purpose: Articulates what makes the organization an attractive place to work.

Example: "Meaningful work, flexibility, growth opportunities, inclusive culture"

Sectors: Business, Nonprofit

Workforce Diversity & Inclusion Plan

Purpose: Formal DEI goals, metrics, and initiatives.

Example: Government DEI strategic plan

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Employee Wellbeing & Resilience Framework

Purpose: Documented structure for mental health, burnout prevention, and workplace support.

Example: Employee assistance program structure

Sectors: Public, Business

Remote Work / Hybrid Work Playbook

Purpose: Governance for distributed workforces.

Example: Hybrid work policies and expectations

Sectors: Public, Business

Knowledge Transfer Plan

Purpose: Template for handing off roles between staff during transitions.

Example: Succession knowledge transfer checklist

Sectors: Public, Business

5. Finance, Budgeting & Resource Management

Budget Book / Budget Narrative / Agency Budget Justification

Purpose: Explains resource requests and financial plans with narrative and numbers.

Example: State agency biennial budget book

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Cost Allocation Plan

Purpose: Explains how shared costs are distributed; required for federal grant recipients.

Example: OMB Uniform Guidance-compliant cost allocation plan

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Long-Range Financial Plan (LRFP)

Purpose: Multi-year financial forecasting (5-10 years).

Example: Municipal long-range financial plan

Sectors: Public

Capital Improvement Plan (CIP)

Purpose: Multi-year plan for major capital investments, infrastructure, and assets.

Example: City CIP for roads, buildings, utilities

Sectors: Public

Financial Controls Framework / Financial Controls Manual

Purpose: Defines financial procedures, expenditure processes, procurement, and auditing.

Example: Nonprofit financial policies handbook

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Grants Management Framework

Purpose: Structure for applying, managing, and reporting on grants.

Example: Federal Uniform Guidance-compliant grants management

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Investment Committee Charter

Purpose: For organizations with reserves, endowments, or capital projects.

Example: Nonprofit endowment investment committee charter

Sectors: Nonprofit

6. Technology, Data & Digital Operations

Digital Transformation Roadmap

Purpose: Outlines modernization priorities, platforms, and timelines.

Example: Government digital service transformation roadmap

Sectors: Public, Business

Information Security Program Charter

Purpose: Defines security authority, responsibilities, and governance.

Example: NIST 800-53 aligned security program charter

Sectors: Public, Business

Data Governance Framework

Purpose: Defines ownership, stewardship, quality, access, and controls for organizational data.

Example: DAMA DMBOK data governance

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Data Architecture Diagram / Information Model

Purpose: Maps core data entities, relationships, and flows.

Example: Enterprise data model

Sectors: Public, Business

IT Service Management Framework

Purpose: Defines processes for IT service delivery.

Example: ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library)

Sectors: Public, Business

API Governance Standards

Purpose: Formalizes how APIs are developed, secured, and managed.

Example: API design standards and security requirements

Sectors: Business, Public

Digital Literacy / Digital Readiness Framework

Purpose: Assesses workforce digital competency.

Example: OECD digital readiness model

Sectors: Public, Business

Information Architecture (IA) Map

Purpose: Structured overview of how information is organized.

Example: Website information architecture

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Innovation Portfolio

Purpose: Organizes innovation initiatives by risk and horizon.

Example: "Horizon 1, 2, 3" innovation framework (core, adjacent, transformational)

Sectors: Business, Consulting

7. Risk, Continuity & Resilience

Risk Management Framework

Purpose: Systematic approach to identifying, assessing, prioritizing, and mitigating organizational risks.

Example: ISO 31000, NIST Risk Management Framework

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Risk Register / Risk Charter

Purpose: Living document tracking all identified risks with severity, likelihood, ownership, and mitigation status.

Example: Enterprise risk register with heat map

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) Framework

Purpose: High-level approach for risk strategy, monitoring, and escalation.

Example: COSO ERM framework

Sectors: Public, Business

Business Impact Analysis (BIA)

Purpose: Identifies critical functions and acceptable downtime.

Example: IT business impact analysis form

Sectors: Public, Business

Continuity of Operations (COOP) Plan

Purpose: Ensures essential services continue during disruptions.

Example: FEMA COOP template

Sectors: Public, Business

Business Continuity Plan (BCP)

Purpose: Procedures for maintaining operations during disasters or system failures.

Example: Disaster recovery procedures, backup systems

Sectors: Public, Business

Crisis Management Plan / Crisis Action Plan (CAP)

Purpose: Defines organizational response to emergencies with chain of authority.

Example: Incident response playbook

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Threat Assessment Framework

Purpose: Identifies and categorizes threats (physical or cyber).

Example: Homeland Security threat matrix

Sectors: Public, Business

Vulnerability Assessment

Purpose: Identifies weaknesses in systems or processes.

Example: NIST cybersecurity vulnerability assessment

Sectors: Public, Business

Continuity Resource Inventory

Purpose: List of essential personnel, assets, and tools required during COOP.

Example: Emergency essential staff roster

Sectors: Public

8. Communications, Engagement & External Relations

Communications Plan / Communications Strategy Framework

Purpose: Defines messaging, channels, audiences, and cadence.

Example: Strategic communications plan for state agency

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

Brand Guidelines / Identity Standards

Purpose: Defines logos, colors, fonts, tone, photography, and visual identity.

Example: City or nonprofit branding manual

Sectors: Nonprofit, Business, Public

Stakeholder Map / Stakeholder Analysis

Purpose: Identifies key stakeholders, their interests, power, and influence.

Example: Power/Interest matrix, Influence/Impact grid

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Purpose: Defines how to engage different stakeholders with tailored strategies.

Example: Constituent engagement plan, donor engagement strategy

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Public Engagement Framework

Purpose: Guides engagement with communities and the public.

Example: IAP2 Spectrum of Engagement

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Leadership Talking Points / Messaging Guide

Purpose: Ensures leaders speak consistently about priorities.

Example: Commissioner briefing points

Sectors: Public, Business

Engagement/Communications Calendar

Purpose: Schedule of announcements, outreach, and engagement touchpoints.

Example: Monthly commissioner newsletters, nonprofit donor communications plan

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Annual Report

Purpose: Summary of yearly activities, accomplishments, and financials.

Example: Nonprofit annual impact report, shareholder annual report

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Transparency Framework

Purpose: Defines what information is proactively published.

Example: Open data policy

Sectors: Public

Public Participation Plan (P3)

Purpose: Defines how the public will be engaged in decision-making.

Example: IAP2 ladder of engagement mapping

Sectors: Public

9. Evaluation, Learning & Improvement

Performance Measurement Framework

Purpose: Defines how success is measured across the organization.

Example: Balanced Scorecard, OKRs, KPI dashboard

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Balanced Scorecard (BSC)

Purpose: Strategic management system measuring performance across 4 perspectives: Financial, Customer, Internal Process, Learning & Growth.

Example: Objectives, measures, targets, and initiatives across each perspective

Sectors: Business, Public

OKR Framework (Objectives & Key Results)

Purpose: Agile goal-setting framework with 2-3 objectives and 3-5 measurable key results per objective, typically quarterly.

Example: Objective: "Launch in mobile market" / Key Results: "1M downloads, 4.5 star rating, 40% retention"

Sectors: Business, Public

KPIs / Metrics Dashboard

Purpose: Selected, measurable values demonstrating how effectively established processes achieve strategic objectives. KPIs function as "ongoing vital signs" monitoring organizational health. Must be clearly defined, measurable, actionable, influential on decisions, and regularly reported. Distinct from metrics (tactical processes/actions like "monthly store visits") which feed into higher-level KPIs (like "targeted monthly revenue").

Example: Customer satisfaction score 85%, response time <2 hours, 95% uptime, conversion rate, ROI

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Theory of Change

Purpose: Structured planning tool mapping the causal logic—the "missing middle"—between organizational activities (interventions) and desired long-term outcomes. Explains how and why desired change is expected to occur under certain conditions. Includes Long-Term Goals, specific Outcomes, Activities, and critical Assumptions (underlying conditions that must exist). Defines the "Value Agenda" for social impact and provides framework for evaluation.

Example: "Providing 1:1 mentorship (Activity) + Academic support → Increased achievement (Outcome) → College enrollment (Long-term Goal)" with assumption "Supportive family environment exists"

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

Logic Model

Purpose: Program-level framework mapping inputs → activities → outputs → outcomes → impact with specific metrics.

Example: Staff + funding → training programs → # trained → skill improvement → job placement rate

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Plan

Purpose: Framework for tracking outputs, outcomes, and impact. Includes both Implementation Studies (proving program is implemented as intended/fidelity) and Impact Studies (establishing whether program generated desired effects/causality). Validates Theory of Change assumptions.

Example: USAID M&E Plan with outcome indicators and data collection methods

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Learning Agenda

Purpose: Planning tool identifying what the organization needs to learn to make better decisions.

Example: Federal agency Evidence Act Learning Agenda

Sectors: Public

Audit Reports (Internal or External)

Purpose: Independent assessment of compliance, performance, or risk.

Example: Legislative Auditor reports, financial audits

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Maturity Model Assessment

Purpose: Rates the organization on levels (1-5) of maturity across capabilities.

Example: CMMI, ITIL maturity, DEI maturity, customer experience maturity

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Reflective Practice Framework / After-Action Review

Purpose: Defines organizational learning routines.

Example: After-action review process

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Organizational Health Index / Culture Scorecard

Purpose: Measures trust, psychological safety, engagement, etc.

Example: McKinsey Organizational Health Index

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Workforce Sentiment Analysis / Employee Listening Strategy

Purpose: Defines how feedback is gathered and used.

Example: Pulse survey + listening posts + engagement surveys

Sectors: Business, Public

10. Program, Project & Portfolio Management

Program Charter

Purpose: Defines the purpose, scope, and boundaries of a program.

Example: Public health program charter

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Project Charter

Purpose: Authorizes a project and defines objectives, scope, and stakeholders.

Example: IT modernization project charter

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Project Governance Plan

Purpose: Decision-making structure for a project.

Example: PMBOK project governance plan

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Portfolio Prioritization Framework

Purpose: Defines how projects are selected and funded.

Example: Weighted scoring model

Sectors: Business, Public

Program/Portfolio Roadmap

Purpose: Timeline showing major initiatives, milestones, and dependencies.

Example: Application modernization roadmap

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Benefits Realization Plan

Purpose: Shows how long-term outcomes and ROI will be tracked.

Example: PMI benefits realization framework

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Resource Plan / Staffing Plan

Purpose: Maps staffing requirements to responsibilities and timeline.

Example: Project resource allocation plan

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

11. Change Management & Organizational Development

Change Management Plan / Change Management Framework

Purpose: Structured approach to implementing organizational change.

Example: Prosci ADKAR model, Kotter's 8-step process

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Change Readiness Assessment

Purpose: Measures cultural and operational readiness for change.

Example: Organizational pulse survey with heat maps

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Change Adoption Plan

Purpose: Different from implementation; focuses on training, communication, and reinforcement.

Example: User adoption strategy

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Transformation Charter / Modernization Charter

Purpose: Defines scope, value, and governance of a major transformation program.

Example: Enterprise transformation charter

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Implementation Playbook / Roadmap

Purpose: Step-by-step "how to do it" guide for execution.

Example: Digital service transformation playbook

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Culture Assessment Report

Purpose: Describes culture strengths, barriers, and archetypes.

Example: Organizational culture diagnostic

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Organizational Culture Framework / Culture Playbook

Purpose: Artifacts articulating desired norms, leadership behaviors, and shared identity.

Example: "Point North" servant-leadership principles, Netflix Culture Deck

Sectors: Business, Public

Sensemaking Framework / Sensemaking Brief

Purpose: Helps leaders interpret complex or ambiguous situations.

Example: Cynefin framework

Sectors: Public, Consulting

Purpose: Shifting mindsets and stories over time.

Example: Advocacy narrative change strategy

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

Symbolic Actions Playbook

Purpose: Identifies rituals, stories, and signals leaders use to reinforce culture.

Example: "First 90 days" symbolic action plan

Sectors: Public, Business

12. Specialized & Sector-Specific Frameworks

PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION SPECIFIC

Briefing Book / Briefing Paper / Executive Briefing Book

Purpose: Distilled, highly skimmable document providing targeted information, analysis, and policy recommendations to decision-makers.

Example: Commissioner's briefing book with "bottom line up front," bulleted findings, and detailed appendices

Sectors: Public

General Statements of Policy / Policy Guidance Documents

Purpose: Advises the public on how the agency intends to exercise its discretionary authority; technically non-binding but practically influential.

Example: Agency guidance on regulatory interpretation

Sectors: Public

Legislative Mandate / Statutory Mission Mandate

Purpose: The legal definition of an agency's mission and authority.

Example: Minnesota statute creating an agency

Sectors: Public

Legislative Agenda

Purpose: Prioritized list of statutes/changes the agency seeks.

Example: Annual legislative priorities

Sectors: Public

Legislative Report / Statutory Report

Purpose: Recurring reports required by state or federal law.

Example: Annual report to legislature on cybersecurity readiness

Sectors: Public

Rulemaking Plan

Purpose: For agencies that adopt administrative rules.

Example: Health or environmental rulemaking schedule

Sectors: Public

Policy Interpretation Bulletins

Purpose: Clarifications for regulated communities.

Example: Tax policy guidance bulletins

Sectors: Public

Interagency Agreement (IAA) / MOU / MOA

Purpose: Defines roles in multi-agency partnerships.

Example: Data-sharing agreement between agencies

Sectors: Public

Public Data Policies

Purpose: Transparency and compliance with data practices laws.

Example: Minnesota Government Data Practices Act compliance

Sectors: Public

Citizen's Guide / Transparency Report

Purpose: Accessible document explaining complex government work in plain language.

Example: "How your government works" guide

Sectors: Public

Accessibility Plan (ADA/508 Compliance)

Purpose: Formal commitment and roadmap for accessibility.

Example: Digital accessibility roadmap

Sectors: Public

Records Retention Schedule

Purpose: Legally required schedule for retention and destruction of records.

Example: State records retention schedule

Sectors: Public

Continuity of Government Plan

Purpose: Protects state governance during emergencies.

Example: COOP for executive agencies

Sectors: Public

NONPROFIT SPECIFIC**Case for Support / Case Statement**

Purpose: Compelling narrative to persuade donors.

Example: Red Cross fundraising case statement

Sectors: Nonprofit

Fundraising Strategy / Development Plan

Purpose: Revenue mix, donor journey, and stewardship approach.

Example: Annual fundraising strategy

Sectors: Nonprofit

Donor Segmentation Framework

Purpose: Categorizes donors by behavior, capacity, and affinity.

Example: Major donors, mid-level, grassroots segmentation

Sectors: Nonprofit

Volunteer Handbook & Volunteer Rights / Volunteer Engagement Framework

Purpose: Governance for non-staff contributors.

Example: Red Cross volunteer guide

Sectors: Nonprofit

Impact Report / Community Benefit Report

Purpose: Narrative and data report distinct from annual report.

Example: Social impact measurement report

Sectors: Nonprofit

Social Impact Framework / Social Return on Investment (SROI)

Purpose: Measures and explains societal value created.

Example: SROI calculation methodology

Sectors: Nonprofit

Partner Value Proposition Canvas

Purpose: Maps partnership benefits and expectations.

Example: Nonprofit partnership planning canvas

Sectors: Nonprofit

Network Governance Model

Purpose: Defines decision-making in collaborative networks.

Example: Collective impact backbone organization roles

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

Coalition / Network Agreements

Purpose: Governance for multi-stakeholder collaborations.

Example: Collective impact coalition agreement

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

BUSINESS / CORPORATE SPECIFIC

Value Proposition / Employer Value Proposition (EVP)

Purpose: What makes the organization attractive.

Example: "Competitive pay, meaningful work, flexibility, growth"

Sectors: Business

Product Strategy

Purpose: Defines product direction and roadmap.

Example: SaaS platform product roadmap

Sectors: Business

Operating Model Blueprint

Purpose: Visual and textual description of structure, decision rights, processes, and systems.

Example: Centralized shared services operating model

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Mission Success Criteria

Purpose: Defines "success" in concrete terms.

Example: NASA mission success criteria

Sectors: Business, Public

Integrity Framework

Purpose: Fraud prevention and ethical controls.

Example: OECD Integrity Framework

Sectors: Business, Public

CONSULTING SPECIFIC**Delivery Framework (Firm-Specific)**

Purpose: Proprietary methodology for engagements.

Example: Deloitte Greenhouse, McKinsey 7S, Bain RAPID

Sectors: Consulting

Statement of Work (SOW) / Engagement Charter

Purpose: Defines deliverables, scope, constraints for consulting project.

Example: Deloitte SOW template

Sectors: Consulting

Diagnostic Toolkit / Discovery Framework

Purpose: Structured tools for evaluating client problems.

Example: SWOT, Root Cause Analysis (Fishbone), McKinsey 7S

Sectors: Consulting

Client Readiness Assessment

Purpose: Assesses whether conditions exist to succeed.

Example: McKinsey change readiness tool

Sectors: Consulting

Hypothesis Tree / Issue Tree

Purpose: Structures diagnostic hypotheses.

Example: MECE (Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive) issue tree

Sectors: Consulting

Blueprint Deck

Purpose: Mid-engagement document outlining proposed solution architecture.

Example: Consulting solution blueprint

Sectors: Consulting

Insights Deck / Synthesis Pack

Purpose: Standardized output summarizing findings and themes.

Example: Executive summary deck

Sectors: Consulting

Heatmap (Capability, Process, Organization)

Purpose: Visual performance ratings across functions.

Example: Capability maturity heatmap

Sectors: Consulting

13. Advanced & Specialized Tools

Design Principles

Purpose: Core tenets guiding design decisions.

Example: "Digital-first," "Accessible by default," "Human-centered"

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Content Strategy Framework

Purpose: Defines voice, tone, taxonomy, and governance.

Example: Web content strategy

Sectors: Public, Business

User Personas

Purpose: Fictional profiles representing different user types.

Example: Civic tech personas

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Environmental Scan / PESTLE Analysis

Purpose: Analysis of Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental forces.

Example: Strategic planning environmental scan

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

SWOT Analysis

Purpose: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats assessment.

Example: Used in retreats and strategic planning

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business, Consulting

Business Case / Problem Statement

Purpose: Formal document justifying a significant project or investment. Bridges strategic intent with project execution by outlining the problem, analyzing options (with pros/cons/costs), recommending a solution, and providing financial appraisal and implementation plan. Ensures informed decision-making and optimal resource prioritization.

Example: Enterprise software investment justification, ERP system business case with ROI analysis

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Scenario Planning / Strategic Foresight Framework

Purpose: Explores plausible futures to inform proactive strategy.

Example: "Future of digital services in 2035" scenario book

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Systems Map / Causal Loop Diagram

Purpose: Models complex interdependent systems.

Example: Public health systems dynamics map

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Consulting

Decision-Making Framework

Purpose: Structured approach to making decisions.

Example: RAPID (Recommend, Agree, Perform, Input, Decide), consent-based decision making

Sectors: Public, Business, Consulting

Ethical Decision Framework

Purpose: Structured lens for decisions involving moral challenges.

Example: Ethics decision tree

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit

Compliance Framework

Purpose: Documentation of laws, regulations, and internal controls.

Example: SOC 2, ISO 27001, GDPR, HIPAA compliance programs

Sectors: Public, Business

Organizational Learning System

Purpose: Infrastructure governing how the org learns, experiments, and adapts.

Example: Toyota "Hoshin Kanri" learning rhythm

Sectors: Business, Consulting

Ethnographic Observation Notes / Organizational Anthropology Reports

Purpose: Deep insight into organizational culture and behavior.

Example: Workplace ethnography report

Sectors: Consulting

Annual Compliance Calendar

Purpose: Lists all mandatory filings, audits, reports, renewals.

Example: HR compliance calendar

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Harassment Prevention & Respectful Workplace Framework

Purpose: System including training, reporting pathways, and restorative practices.

Example: Respectful workplace program

Sectors: Public, Business

Principles of Practice / Standards of Professional Conduct

Purpose: Sector-specific behavioral norms beyond general ethics.

Example: NASW standards for social work, Agile Manifesto principles

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Operating Constraints List ("Guardrails")

Purpose: Explicit description of non-negotiables.

Example: Budget constraints, regulatory requirements

Sectors: Public, Business

Executive Briefing Book / Principal's Book

Purpose: Comprehensive reference for executives with key info, contacts, and context.

Example: Commissioner's briefing book

Sectors: Public

Equity Framework / DEI Framework

Purpose: Organizational commitment and plan related to equity, diversity, inclusion.

Example: State DEI strategic plan, DEI charter

Sectors: Public, Nonprofit, Business

Leadership Development Curriculum

Purpose: Formal structure for leadership training.

Example: Multi-level leadership program

Sectors: Public, Business

Culture Code

Purpose: Defines informal but codified workplace behavioral expectations.

Example: Netflix Culture Deck

Sectors: Business

Impact Manifesto / Change Statement

Purpose: Public statement of intended societal value.

Example: Patagonia's "Our reason for being"

Sectors: Nonprofit, Business

Outcome Chain / Benefits Realization Map

Purpose: Links outputs → intermediate outcomes → ultimate impacts.

Example: Theory of Change outcome pathway

Sectors: Nonprofit, Public

14. Cross-Sector Comparative Analysis

Understanding why artifacts vary across sectors requires examining the different motivational and regulatory drivers:

Comparative Drivers of Foundational Artifacts

Driver Category	Business / Consulting	Nonprofit	Public Administration
Primary Motivation	Profit maximization, Shareholder value, Market capture	Mission attainment, Social impact, Donor trust	Legislative mandate, Public accountability, Rule of law
Key Governance Artifacts	Corporate Charter, Governance Guidelines, Operating Model, Shareholder Agreements	Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, Conflict of Interest Policy, Whistleblower Policy	Constitution/Charter, Enabling Legislation, Legislative Rules, General Policy Statements
Strategic Planning Model	Operating Model (execution focus), Business Case (ROI justification)	Theory of Change (causal logic justification), Logic Model	Policy White Papers, Strategic Plans, Budget Requests, Briefing Papers
Accountability Focus	Financial performance, Efficiency, Revenue/growth KPIs, Shareholder returns	Program impact, Cost per outcome, Social ROI, Fiduciary duty to mission	Stewardship over assets, Budgetary control, Transparency (CAFR), Service delivery metrics
Mandate Source	Market forces, Shareholders, Contractual obligations (SOW), Competition	IRS 501(c)(3) rules, State incorporation laws, Funder requirements	Congressional/Legislative delegation of authority, Constitutional framework
Performance Measurement	Financial KPIs, Market share, Operational efficiency, Customer acquisition	Social impact metrics, Outcomes achieved, Program evaluation, Cost-effectiveness	Public satisfaction, Service levels, Regulatory compliance, Financial stewardship
Primary Stakeholders	Shareholders, Customers, Employees, Market	Beneficiaries, Donors, Volunteers, Community	Citizens/Constituents, Legislators, Taxpayers, Other government entities

Key Insights from Comparative Analysis:

1. **Universal Structure, Different Drivers:** While the motivational drivers differ profoundly—profit (business), mission (nonprofit), mandate (public)—the structure of effective leadership is remarkably similar across sectors.
2. **Strategy-to-Performance Consistency:** All sectors require a unified, internally consistent document ecosystem where stable foundations (Purpose, Values) dictate adaptive structures (Operating Model, Theory of Change), which dictate measurement systems (KPIs, Evaluation Reports).
3. **Cross-Sector Literacy:** Modern leadership increasingly requires understanding artifacts across sectors. A public administrator must grasp business cases for public-private partnerships; business consultants must understand Theories of Change for social enterprise clients; nonprofit leaders must understand legislative processes for advocacy.
4. **Accountability Mechanisms Vary:** Business accountability flows primarily through financial performance to shareholders; nonprofit accountability flows through mission impact to donors and beneficiaries; public sector accountability flows through transparency and stewardship to citizens and legislative bodies.
5. **Document Complexity Trap:** Regardless of sector, overly complex strategic documents diminish visibility and accountability. Effective leaders streamline artifacts, prioritize clarity, and link them directly to performance mechanisms.

Total Artifacts Catalogued: 185+

This master list represents the most comprehensive compilation of organizational, leadership, strategic, operational, and governance artifacts used across public administration, nonprofit leadership, business administration, and management consulting.